

CliftonStrengths® for Students

Welcome to CliftonStrengths for Students, the report that guides you through your unique talents and how you can use those talents to succeed in your role.

We designed this report to make your days easier, bring clarity to your role as a student and help you thrive academically, socially and in your future career.

Use this report to learn about your results and better understand what you naturally do best as a student. Then, go implement the action items into your role responsibilities — starting today.

YOUR TOP FIVE THEMES

1. Analytical

Use your logical, objective approach to make important decisions.

2. Relator

Connect deeply with the right people to gain friends for life.

3. Competition

Aim for first place so you'll always finish strong.

4. Futuristic

Share your visions of a better future.

5. Responsibility

Take ownership for the things that matter most to you.

Each Theme Fits Into a Leadership Domain

■ **EXECUTING** themes help you make things happen.

■ **INFLUENCING** themes help you take charge, speak up and make sure others are heard.

■ **RELATIONSHIP BUILDING** themes help you build strong relationships that hold a team together.

■ **STRATEGIC THINKING** themes help you absorb and analyze information that informs better decisions.

Your Strongest Future Begins Here



- 1. Analytical
- 2. Relator
- 3. Competition
- 4. Futuristic
- 5. Responsibility

This time in your life is filled with choices, changes and challenges. Being a student requires so much of your time and energy — and no two students have the same experience, which means there must be more than one way to succeed. We know that the best way to build a foundation for success, both as a student and well into the future, is by using your strengths.

Your distinct CliftonStrengths profile sets you apart from every other student. Above is your talent DNA, shown in order based on your responses to the assessment.

Learn About Your Most Powerful Strengths

This report outlines how your natural strengths give you an advantage during your time as a student. But to fully understand your talent DNA, you must know that your top five themes — the ones that shine through in almost everything you do — are the *most powerful*. Take the time to learn more about them.

Discover Practical Ways to Apply Them

Incorporate your strengths into your day-to-day routine: from choosing your class schedule and creating study habits to investing in extracurricular activities and relationships with classmates.

Each theme page includes:

- How that theme contributes to your success
- How that theme could get in the way of your success
- Action items that you can implement immediately

Use Them

You have strengths that are already within you; it's your specific talents, along with how you use them, that gives you your power and edge over others. Regardless of what you're doing in academia and where you're going next, you'll need to truly use and develop your strengths to create long-term and sustainable success.



STRATEGIC THINKING

1. Analytical®

You search for reasons and causes. You have the ability to think about all of the factors that might affect a situation.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You ask great questions. You may spend time during your teacher's office hours asking in-depth questions or in class encouraging your teacher or classmates to go deeper in their thinking. You know that to truly learn, questions must come before thinking. Others often worry about asking too many questions, but you don't shy away.

The academic work you submit is well-researched and accurate. You enjoy classwork that has definitive answers. Because of your need to have everything proven, you also want to establish the truth. For assignments, papers, discussions and projects, you research to gather all the facts and information because having the supporting data compels you to do so.

Whether it's an assignment, a class discussion or a problem, because you ask profound questions, others notice new things. You aren't satisfied with superficial relationships — whether it's a teacher or classmate. You ask questions that lead others to self-discovery. Others often say to you, "I never thought of asking that" or "I hadn't considered that before."

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Your questions may come across as if you disbelieve the speaker or topic. Teachers and classmates might feel like you are interrogating them because of the volume of questions you ask. They may wonder if you are genuinely curious and motivated by the truth or asking questions because you doubt them. Consider your motives, and ask questions to help you develop as a student.
- You may slow yourself or others down as you strive to have all the facts. In group settings, you might get others off schedule, jeopardizing the deadline or monopolizing group time to answer your own questions. On your own, you struggle to know when to stop researching and when to act, which can get overwhelming as your classwork piles up.
- Classes or topics that exclude possibilities may be difficult for you. While you see the value in these classes, it might be hard to understand more abstract work like poetry or literature. There will be required classes you don't want to take, and when certain topics don't include data or have definite outcomes, you may struggle to find the energy to complete the work.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Analytical as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Reflect on the questions you ask in the classroom.** Your inquisitive, deep-thinking nature brings so much value to the process of learning. Intentionally consider what kinds of questions you ask and what kinds you should ask more of. Consider where others, including your teacher, need you to ask more profound questions.
- ☐ **Make your research process more efficient.** You love the research part of schoolwork. Consider ways to do your in-depth research faster and to acknowledge when you have enough. Write down your ideal research and data collection process, and then look at where you could cut time gathering data while keeping the most important parts. Knowing why and how you do things will help you stay focused.
- ☐ **Find a thinking partner to help you navigate your future.** Whether it's a guidance counselor, academic advisor, mentor or friend, consider sharing the way you think with someone else. As you navigate the choices for your future that are quickly approaching, you may need a partner who will help motivate you to move from thinking to action.
- ☐ **Sign up for a class or activity that will challenge you.** You have classwork that you're very comfortable with. Now enroll in or sign up for something that will force you to do new research, ask different questions or make you think creatively. This will boost your analytical skills, putting you in a better position for your future.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What classes do you like and dislike the most? Do you notice any themes?

How do you approach complex research, and why?



RELATIONSHIP BUILDING

2. Relator®

You enjoy close relationships. You find deep satisfaction in working hard with friends to achieve a goal.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You build strong relationships and trust with those you know. You are more comfortable having conversations that lead to learning the details of someone's life than having just casual talks. In school, you are the classmate others can rely on. They know they can ask you for guidance and expect you to be there for them — because you always have been.

You likely prefer smaller class sizes and close-knit group work. You probably feel more comfortable asking questions, participating in group discussions and choosing classmates to work with because it is easier to get to know people. You want to get to know others on a deeper level and have them fully know you in return.

People respect you and enjoy being around you. You make others feel comfortable as you get to know them because you genuinely want to understand their feelings. In fact, whether in an academic, social or extracurricular activity setting, you can spot the potential in others by helping them see their talent, open up and feel connected to the group around them.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Others may feel left out because you are naturally drawn to staying with the people you know. It's much less natural for you to gravitate toward new people because you tend to get your strength from being around those you're closest to. You may miss out on new opportunities for friendships if you don't invite other students into your circle.
- It may be overwhelming for you to be in larger class settings. Because you derive your energy from closer and fewer relationships, being around a lot of people, especially new people, can drain you. When you attend networking events like career fairs, scholarship functions or social gatherings, your energy levels can deplete quickly, and you may even feel stressed.
- You may have a hard time when a relationship ends or when you feel like someone doesn't reciprocate the effort you put into a relationship. Friendships and classmate relationships change over time, which may be hard for you to understand. Even beginning a new class, activity or school can be challenging because you have to start those relationships all over again.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Relator as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Make time to meet one on one with new people.** Talk to your teacher about what success in their class looks like. Go on a walk with a classmate you don't know well. Study with someone you'd like to befriend. By opening yourself up to creating new relationships, you can expand your network and maximize your time as a student.
- ☐ **Find a role where you can mentor someone.** Help a younger student navigate their classes. Become a long-term tutor or study partner for a classmate. Knowing you will have a long-lasting relationship with someone will give you the freedom to continually strengthen and deepen that friendship, all while helping that person out.
- ☐ **Make a list of your best supporters.** You know who you love, trust and depend on. Take time to reflect on their support. When school and life become busy or overwhelming, whom do you call? Who is always there for you when you need it most? Take time for gratitude, and consider writing this person a note or calling them to thank them.
- ☐ **Create partnership-based study habits.** When studying, you might work more efficiently if you have a partner to consider ideas with, ask questions and quiz each other. Try finding a steady study partner for each class (whether it's one person or a few) to meet your need for social interaction and learn better.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What do others depend on you for? Why do they rely on you?

How can you develop friendships with new people?

**INFLUENCING**

3. Competition®

You measure your progress against the performance of others. You love contests and need to win.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You're motivated to win and succeed in academics and extracurricular activities. You push hard for excellence and always compete against others and yourself. You don't tire easily because the energy of a competition keeps you going. You are constantly comparing yourself to obvious metrics like grades, class rankings, etc., while also creating your own personal winning metrics.

You have intense standards that are hard to meet. You are motivated by the fact that others around you are also striving for good grades, honor roll, student government and more. But you're not just *willing* to compete — you *must* compete. Your sights are set on getting into the best programs, getting the biggest scholarships, finishing a test first or having the best project.

You inspire others, and your tenacity energizes the classroom. Your teachers can rely on the fact that you will always try your hardest. You are not a passive participant in class discussions and care deeply about learning outcomes. In group project settings, you bring others along with you. Your success becomes their success, which your classmates appreciate.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Sometimes you focus on winning over learning. You may forget to follow the learning objectives in your attempt to compete and win. Coming in first can be motivating, but it's no longer healthy when you aren't learning or retaining information. Sometimes losing is OK if it means you learned. Failure is an essential part of learning; this is something that is difficult for you to accept.
- Others might not see you as someone who works well with others because you sometimes put a grade or outcome above people. A "win at all costs" mentality can harm relationships, and when it comes to academics, you'll want to have a reliable social network as you look at what's next in your life. Don't jeopardize relationships with classmates or teachers for the sake of winning.
- Your expectations for others may be too high. Not everyone has the same drive to win as you. When you partner with these classmates, try to see their perspectives. You may interpret their noncompetitive behavior as not taking things seriously, when in reality, you may be the one with skewed expectations. This causes you to miss others' individual talents.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Competition as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Measure your performance in a new way.** In addition to grades, set learning goals and focus on retaining information. Doing this can help you concentrate on acquiring knowledge rather than just getting good grades. Think about what subjects and topics you want to be an expert in and how you will measure that. Learning more today means winning more tomorrow.
- ☐ **Prevent competition fatigue by prioritizing your involvement.** Make a list of everything you're currently involved in and everything you want to be involved in. You bring intense energy to everything you do, so make sure you focus on where you really want to win and consider saying no to the tasks, classes or extracurricular activities that don't contribute to your overall goals.
- ☐ **Set the standard for excellence in group projects.** With your group members' help, set ambitious goals. Ask others what success looks like to them to create metrics and goals that everyone will be proud of. Let your classmates know how invested you are in the project and what the outcomes mean to you. Aligning on outcomes early will be important to the group's success.
- ☐ **Decide who needs to know about your successes.** Part of succeeding means sharing your wins with others, which motivates you as you track your progress and helps you set challenging goals for your future. Break down these goals into smaller, more achievable ones. Communicate to someone you admire that you are competing against yourself.

Reflect to Plan for Action

**What's a recent win you're proud of?
Reflect on what made it successful.**

**Whom can you talk to when you're
disappointed with a loss? Invest in that
relationship.**



STRATEGIC THINKING

4. Futuristic®

You vividly imagine the future. You inspire and energize others with your vision of what could be.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You are always thinking about the future. This means you hardly do anything without thinking first of its implications. You have a vision that goes beyond your time in school. Because of this, you have an energetic, creative perspective that keeps you excited and dreaming. This joy may show up often at the beginning of a new semester because of the new possibilities.

Because you can envision long-term goals, you know what you should do today to achieve them. You can prioritize your current tasks because what you see in the future informs your decisions. Whether it is a class, an area of study or an extracurricular activity, you know what to do to get to the next step.

You appreciate visibility, meaning you always want to know what's coming next to prepare for it. You enjoy an organized syllabus that details the coming weeks and months, and you appreciate lesson overviews or summaries of expectations from teachers. These help you to be strategic about how you'll work and what you'll work on first.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- While you may know the steps to take to achieve your goals, you might need more motivation to complete those tasks. In fact, you may become overwhelmed by the amount of time or effort that stands between you and the future you want. It may take many years of school, multiple internships, changing jobs or more to reach your goal, which can feel discouraging.
- Others may have a tough time understanding what you're saying. Your focus on the future may make you sound like too much of a dreamer. This is true especially during group projects or in your clubs or extracurricular activities. Others may think you share too broad a vision for the future and see you as someone who can't focus on the current task.
- You may have a hard time staying in the present, and others might see you as distracted. Your friends, academic advisor, teachers or others may get frustrated because they feel like they are less important than the thoughts in your head. In fact, you may appear overly optimistic about what's next and could even ignore the existing challenges.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Futuristic as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Schedule a few minutes each day to enjoy the moment you're in.** Really consider where you are right now. Take time for your mental and educational wellbeing by focusing on your current needs, not just your future ones. Whether you take a walk with a friend, read something unrelated to school or plan your daily tasks, try getting energy from today — not just the future.
- ☐ **Break down your long-term goals into short-term ones.** Write out your long-term objectives, and then think about what steps you need to take to achieve them. You can increase your short-term motivation by dividing your future goals into more detailed ones. Finished that internship, huge project or club involvement? Check it off your list, and you're already closer.
- ☐ **Use your future-oriented mindset to motivate others.** Some people are fixed on the past or present, so it's hard to see what's next. Try volunteering as a peer advisor or mentoring a younger student. You excel at motivating others to visualize and explore their goals for the future. This can also be a great thing to add to your résumé or mention in a job interview.
- ☐ **Think about the career you want.** Even if you don't know exactly what you want to do, visualizing a specific job can help you learn early on if that's something you really want. Picture an interesting career; now, imagine your days doing that. Change up your routine to match what that career might involve. This process could help you decide what future job is right for you.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What's your top goal? What are you doing today to achieve it?

How can you help others see their potential and get excited about the future?

**EXECUTING**

5. Responsibility®

You take psychological ownership of your commitments. You are dependable and embrace values such as honesty and loyalty.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You are a trustworthy student who's always aware of what's coming next. Your work is on time and consistent because you understand that your efforts will directly correlate to your outcomes. You don't leave your grades, friendships or extracurricular activity involvement to chance — instead, you put effort into everything you've said you would do.

In group scenarios, academic or otherwise, you ensure the group is on track and the work is done correctly. When your group makes a commitment, you personally take it on as your own. You feel a sense of ownership to ensure you hit goals and meet expectations. Your teachers trust your word because you always do what you say you'll do.

Others know that they can count on you. You take on the roles and responsibilities that you commit to with pride. And as you fulfill your promises, you strengthen relationships with your classmates and teachers. You may also be apt to say yes to extra credit or volunteer opportunities because you want to increase your responsibilities beyond academics.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- You put immense pressure on yourself to be successful. The fear of disappointing people preoccupies you because letting others down feels like a failure. You likely have a hard time recovering from mistakes because you're worried your teachers or classmates are frustrated with you. These concerns can occupy much of your time and energy.
- Saying no might not come easily to you. Regardless of how much you have to do, you often say yes to helping others, taking on more work in a group project or meeting up with friends even when you don't have time. You want to be available for others when they need you to be, but this can come at the cost of your wellbeing.
- You may come off as controlling because you struggle to let others help you. It might be hard to delegate tasks because you prefer ownership over their completion, so you might micromanage your classmates' work when doing projects together. Inwardly, you may not trust that others will work with the same quality and commitment as you, but this can harm your relationships.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Responsibility as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Delegate tasks in a group project setting.** This may not feel natural initially, but allow yourself to give things up. It's just temporary, and checking others' work or reviewing before submitting is OK. You don't have to ignore your attention to detail and commitment to excellence, but you can help others improve by giving them a chance to succeed and then reviewing their work.
- ☐ **Set aside time to invest in yourself.** Mark your calendar or schedule with designated time to replenish your energy and take time for yourself. This could look like getting coffee on the way to class, going on a walk before studying, spending a weekend morning with a friend or something else. Give yourself the same commitment that you give to others.
- ☐ **Consider a few people who could support you.** Whom do you feel safe asking for help? Whom can you call when you need to process an idea or study for an overwhelming test? Ask this person or these people to help you identify where you're doing too much and where you need to spend more of your time. This outside perspective can be very helpful.
- ☐ **Prioritize your commitments based on your goals.** As a student, you're continually working toward your future. Think about your volunteering, classwork, extracurricular activities, job or clubs. Then, write down your goals. What are you involved in now that is helping you get closer to them? Prioritize those things so you feel more aligned with your goals.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What are some positive motivators for you? What fears tend to hold you back?

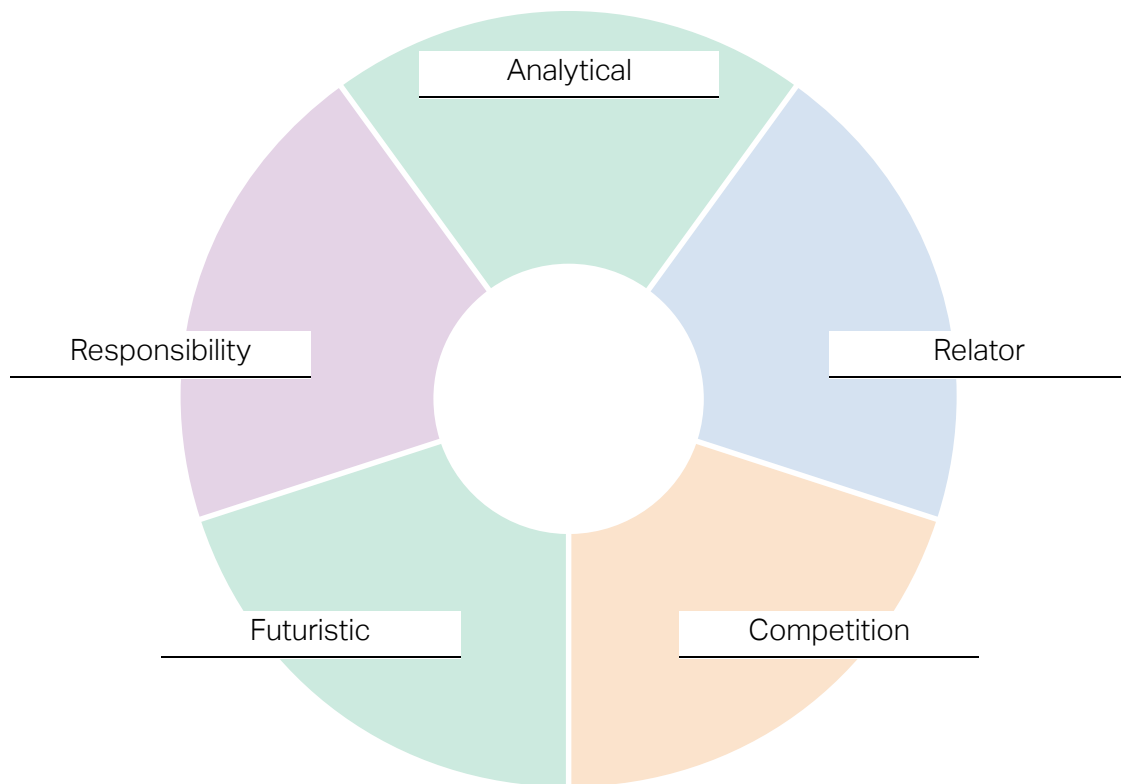
Where have you overcommitted your time and energy in the past?

Accomplish Your Goals

There's no "one right way" to succeed as a student. You'll get the best results by building on who you already are. But talents don't turn into strengths right away; you must continually aim them at your goals and the outcomes you desire most.

With a commitment to using your strengths, this report becomes the first step you take on the road to success selling.

Write your most meaningful goal in the center of the circle. Next, think about the themes you can use to achieve this goal to help you answer the questions below.



How will you use your strengths to reach this goal?

How will you know you have been successful?

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